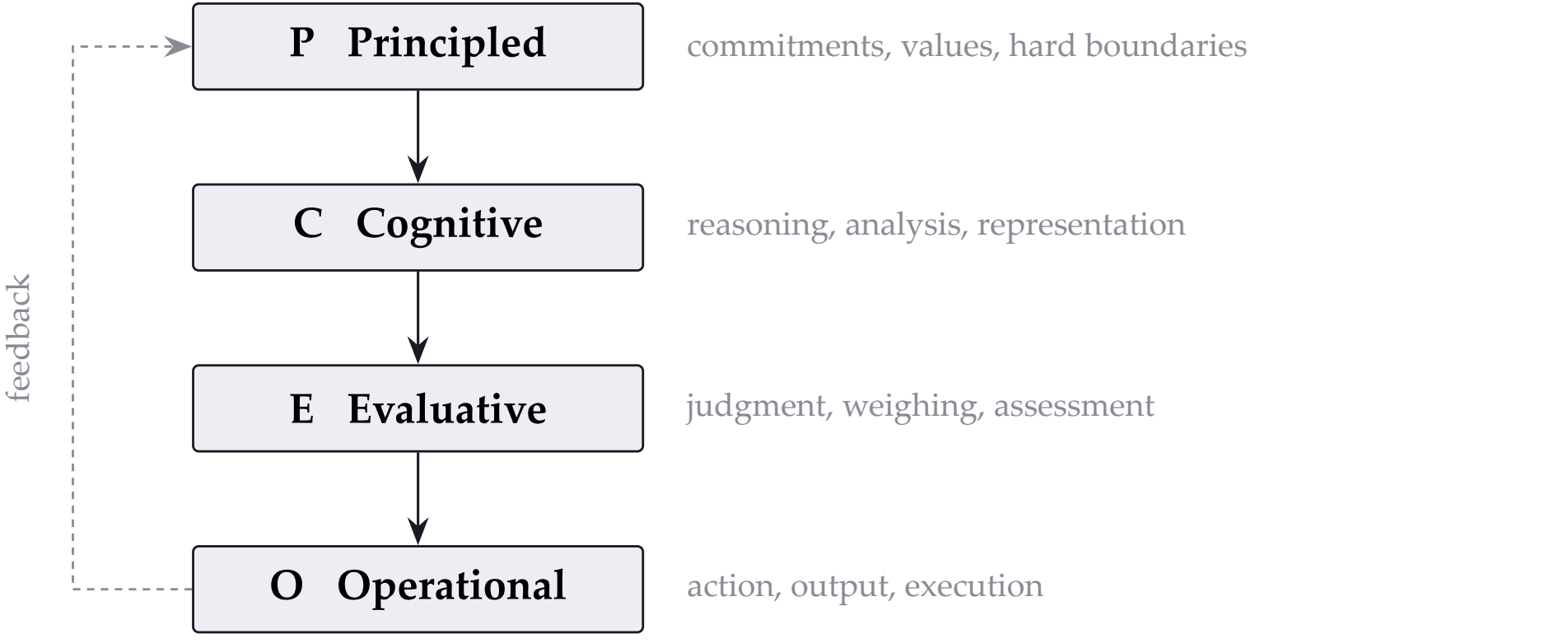

Descent is causal precedence: $P \succ C \succ E \succ O$. The return path carries signal, not authority.